IQMS User Letter 40 – PTC handling for Intra-Uterine System (IUS) products

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Scope: Mirena, Jaydess, Kyleena, Fleree, Janess, Levonorgestrel IUS (LNG-IUS), Skyla
Applicable to: CQU, GBS, RQU

1. Introduction

This User Letter clarifies criteria for IQMS PTC+AE complaint processing for Intra-Uterine System (IUS) products. It further clarifies when cases are entered in IQMS and when cases require technical investigation.
IUS cases reporting an AE and IUS cases reporting an AE with Use Related Issues / Other Issues as defined in the tables below do not require a PTC+AE case investigation in IQMS. In alignment with Risk Management procedures, these cases will be periodically reviewed and monitored by the responsible Quality Assurance functions within Product Supply.

2. IUS cases reporting an AE:

IUS cases reporting an AE: Examples of IUS cases reporting AEs that do not require a case entry in IQMS or a technical investigation in IQMS are in Table 1 below:

Table 1: AE Case Examples (not comprehensive)

AE	Criteria	Example	IQMS Entry?	IQMS Investigation?
Perforation	Without reference to product breakage or deformation, device malfunction or usability issue.	Patient experienced nausea and pain. HCP realized that there had been a perforation and removed the unit.	No	No
Embedment	Without reference to product breakage, product deformation, or device malfunction or usability issue.	Patient came into the office due to reported pain. Ultrasound showed that the unit was embedded so the unit was removed.	No	No
Expulsion	Without reported product defect (e.g. the t-body arms did not open correctly) or breakage or malfunction or usability issue.	Patient brought the IUS into the office the day after the insertion and wants a replacement unit since it came out.	No	No
Bleeding Events	Without reference to product breakage, product deformation, or device malfunction or usability issue.	Patient came into the office for an IUS check, with report of bleeding. The IUS was still in place, but was removed at patients request.	No	No
Infection	With no additional information of a procedural, usability, or technical issue.	Pelvic infection reported a year after insertion.	No	No
Medication Error	n.a.	Expired IUS device was inserted by the physician.	No	No
Dislocation	With no additional information of a procedural, usability, or technical issue.	After six weeks, an ultrasound was performed and IUS was low-lying.	No	No

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AE	Criteria	Example	IQMS Entry?	IQMS Investigation?
Pain	Without additional information of a procedural, usability, or technical issue	Patient reports pain e.g. abdominal pain, pelvic pain or back pain	No	No
Pregnancy / Pregnancy related complications	Without additional information of a procedural, usability, or technical issue	Report refers to e.g. an ectopic pregnancy, pre-term labor, abortion, premature birth	No	No
Lack of effect[1]	Without additional information of a procedural, usability, or technical issue	HCP reports a contraceptive failure	No	No
[1] please also refer to general guidance for LODE cases (PTC is required if a confirmation of product quality is requested, or a suspicion of counterfeit or a quality/technical issue is reported, or if a sample is provided)				

3. IUS cases reporting an AE with Use Related Issues / Other Issues:

All cases qualified as "PTC+AE" require IQMS case entry and technical investigation, however there are two exceptions as shown in Table 2. If the criteria are met as outlined below, Failed Insertion and/or complication of insertion cases are entered in IQMS but do not require a technical investigation and are closed as an unprocessable complaint; Threads not visible or unable to feel do not require IQMS entry or technical investigation. Both these complaint scenarios are periodically reviewed and monitored by Quality Assurance functions of Product Supply (in alignment with Risk Management Procedures)".

Table 2: PTC+AE exceptions (comprehensive)

AE	Criteria	Example	IQMS Entry	IQMS Investigation?
Failed insertion and/or complication of insertion	Without reference to product breakage or device malfunction.	Patient had pain and could not tolerate the insertion attempt.	Yes	No
		Patient experienced nausea and felt faint during the procedure and asked for the procedure to be stopped.	Yes	No
Threads not visible or unable to feel	Without reference to product breakage or device malfunction.	Patient had an IUS inserted 1-1/2 years ago and could not feel the threads. At an office visit the physician could not feel or see the threads and noticed that the IUS had migrated/perforated.	No	No

Abbreviations: AE = Adverse Event; IUS = Intra-uterine System; HCP = Healthcare Professional; LODE = Lack of Drug Effect; PTC = Product Technical Complaint

Note: introduced changes are in blue

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